

award of both stock options, which are intended to qualify for tax treatment under Section 422 of the Internal Revenue Code, and nonqualified stock options, as well for the award of restricted stock awards ("RSAs"), stock appreciation rights ("SARs"), restricted stock units (RSUs), and performance and stock bonus awards. Pursuant to the 2021 Plan, NQ stock options may be granted only to our team members. Since September 2021, we have issued RSUs for grants of shares of the Company's common stock, the vesting of which is based on the requisite service requirement. Generally, the Company's RSUs are subject to forfeiture and are expected to vest over two to four years ratably on a combination of bi-annual and quarterly basis. For RSU Grant Cadence and Vesting please see the following slide deck

Sell-to-cover - RSUs

Shares are sold to pay the taxes due on the RSU vesting. This is an automatic sale and the shares sold are based on the tax rate for your country. For example, if 100 shares vest, and your tax rate is 30%, then 30 shares will be sold to cover the tax and the remaining shares will be placed in your ETRADE account. Taxation for selling of options or GitLab stock owned:

Taxation of Ordinary Income - RSU - More Detail

- Compensation - At the time of vest for RSUs, you will recognize ordinary income equal to the cash value of the shares that vest.
- Tax Liability - Your tax obligation will be based on current tax rates due at the time of vest. A portion of the shares are sold to pay your tax liability. For each country, your local tax rates are used.
- For example, for U.S. team members tax withholding at the time of vest is computed using your federal supplemental tax rate (a fixed percentage), plus state and local and other applicable taxes- such as disability, FICA and Social Security.
- Remaining Shares - The remaining shares from your RSU grants are fully owned by you and deposited in your ETrade Securities stock plan account.

(You should always consult with your own tax advisor concerning how holding periods, capital gains and losses, and your personal circumstances may affect your taxes, and before taking any action that may have tax consequences. Your actual taxes paid will vary depending on your personal circumstances.)

Please note that all tax withholding is based on tax rates provided by Baker McKenzie - You can find our current Tax Matrix [here](#)

Employee Stock Purchase Plan ("ESPP")

What is an ESPP?

An ESPP is a benefit GitLab offers that allows team members to optionally purchase shares of their company's stock at a discount through regular payroll deductions over specified Offering Periods.

In September 2021, the Company's board of directors and its stockholders approved the 2021 Employee Stock Purchase Plan ("ESPP") to enable eligible team members to purchase shares of the Company's Class A common stock with accumulated payroll deductions and provides a 15% purchase price discount of the fair market value of the Company's Class A common stock on the IPO date

or purchase date, whichever is lower. The 2021 ESPP also provides up to a 24-month look-back period with four purchase dates in May and November of each year, and the first purchase occurred in May 2022.

Eligibility Requirements

1. Team member is employed via a GitLab entity with 50+ headcount
1. Team members work more than 20 hours per week.
1. Must be actively employed at the beginning of the Offering Period to enroll
1. Must be actively employed on the last date of the Purchase Period to be able to purchase
1. Eligible ESPP GitLab Entities
 - GITLAB CANADA CORP. (Canada)
 - GitLab GmbH (Germany)
 - GitLab B.V. (Netherlands/Belgium/Finland)
 - GitLab Inc. (US)
 - GitLab Federal, LLC (US)
 - GitLab UK Limited (United Kingdom)
 - GITLAB PTY LTD (Australia/New Zealand)
 - GITLAB IRELAND LIMITED (Ireland)
 - Gitlab France S.A.S. (France) - as of 2025-06-01

Changing Contribution Amounts

- Contribution increases and decreases are limited during Offering and Purchase Periods
- Increases: Team members may not increase their contributions after the Offering Period begins.
- Decreases: Team Members may decrease their contribution rates once during any Offering Period.

Stop Contributions

- Team members may reduce their contribution to 0% during an offering period.
- Any prior contributions will be used to purchase shares on the scheduled purchase date.
- At the end of the offering period, the team member will be automatically withdrawn from the offering period effective as of the day after the purchase date following the date of the request.
- Team members would need to re-enroll as a new participant in the next open enrollment window and begin a new Offering Period if they wish to participate in the future.

Withdrawals

- Team members may withdraw from the ESPP at any time and receive a refund of their withheld contributions. The refunds are processed through Payroll.
- Team members who withdraw would need to re-enroll in order to participate in future Offering Periods.

Details on eligibility, enrollment, calculations, pricing and dollar value can be found at ESPP Training Deck

Alternate ESPP Non-US

The Alternate ESPP is for team members not eligible for the ESPP, mainly in PEO countries. Team Members in the Alternate ESPP will be eligible to receive RSUs on the expected earnings as if they would have been able to participate in the ESPP. There are no payroll deductions or contributions required. The RSUs will be automatically granted to team members as calculated by the following formula for each 6 month purchase period: Details on eligibility, enrollment, calculations, pricing and dollar value can be found at ESPP Training Deck

What is an Offering Period?

- The Offering Period consists of a 24-month period beginning on the applicable Enrollment Date and includes four six-month Purchase Periods.
- Team members can only be enrolled in one Offering Period at a time.
- Your Offering Period might be different from the one your coworker is enrolled in.

ESPP Calendar for Offering periods can be found at ESPP Training Deck

When do Purchases Occur?

On the respective Purchase Dates at the end of each Purchase Period. Only whole shares can be purchased. Purchase dates are normally May 31 and November 30 of each year.

Other ESPP references

- ESPP FAQs
- ESPP/RSU Vesting AMA
- ESPP 101

Grant Levels

RSUs and at times Option Grants (Option Grants are rare since September 2021) are determined by Grade Level. If you have any questions on what grant should be offered to a new hire, please reach out to the Compensation and Benefits team by email to total-rewards@gitlab.com. References and information for Grant Levels is held within the compensation calculator.

Note: All stock options and RSU grants are subject to approval by the Board of Directors and no grants are final until such approval has been made. The Company reserves the right in its own determination to make any adjustments to stock option grants at its sole discretion including the decision not to make a grant at all.

Promotions

Promotion grants are based on the differential between the new hire equity dollar value at the new grade minus the new hire equity dollar value at the current grade using the median of the compensation range. The vesting schedule for the new equity grant will align to the terms and conditions of the equity plan for RSUs.

Formula for number of Promotion Equity Grant: (New Hire Equity Grant Dollar Value Median at Promoted Level - New Hire Equity Grant Dollar Value Median at Previous Level)

For example, if my current role is Backend Engineer and the median new hire equity grant dollar

value grant for my role, level, and location is 20,000 USD, and I am promoted to Senior Backend Engineer and the median new hire equity grant dollar value for that role, level, and location is 40,000 USD, the calculation would be: $40,000 \text{ USD} - 20,000 \text{ USD} = 20,000 \text{ USD}$.

The output of this calculation will also be compared to 0.5x of the Refresh Equity Grant Dollar Value Median at the Promoted Level. If this calculation yields a higher dollar value than the standard Promotion Equity Grant Formula then this value will be used for the promotional grant value.

Refresh Grants

As part of the updated Annual Compensation Review process, eligible GitLab team members will be reviewed for a refresh grant once per year. Refresh grants use the formula above to determine the range of equity dollar value a team member may be eligible for in that cycle based on their current role/grade. Refresh grants will vest in accordance with the equity plan agreement between GitLab and the team members.

Note: All equity grants are subject to approval by the Board of Directors and no grants are final until such approval has been obtained. The company reserves the right in its sole discretion to make any adjustments to equity grants including the decision not to make a grant at all.

Annual Refresh Grant Program Eligibility

Team members may be eligible to participate in the annual refresh grant cycle review if they have completed six months of service with the company. However, participation will be based upon individual team member talent assessments (including if a team member is currently in good standing) and key talent criteria. Therefore, not all team members will receive a refresh grant in the annual review cycle. Leaders will have discretion on the size of the refresh grant based on talent assessments and equity budget as allocated to each E-group member's division. All proposed grants will be reviewed by the People team for pay equality. All proposed equity grants are subject to review and approval by the GitLab Board of Directors.

Option Vesting

Vesting means that you have to remain employed by, or are otherwise a service provider to, GitLab for a certain period of time before you can fully own the stock under your stock option grant. Instead of giving you the right to purchase and own all of the common stock under your stock option on day one, you get to own the stock under your stock option in increments over time. This process is called vesting and different companies offer vesting schedules of different lengths. At GitLab, our standard practice is to issue options with a four year vesting schedule so you would own a quarter of your stock after 12 months, half of your stock after two years, and all of it after 4 years. Vesting happens on a monthly basis after the first year for new hire grants and monthly after grant for refresh grants. A cliff on a new hire grant is the period at the beginning of the vesting period where your equity does not vest monthly, but instead vests at the end of the cliff period. At most companies, including GitLab, this cliff period is generally one year. This means that if you leave your job either voluntarily or involuntarily before you've worked for a whole year, none of your options will be vested. At the end of that year, you'll vest the entire year's worth (12 months) of equity all at once. This helps keep the ownership of GitLab stock to team members who have worked at

the company for a meaningful amount of time.

RSU Vesting & Grant Cadence

RSUs are grants of shares of the Company's common stock, the vesting of which is based on the requisite service requirement. Generally, the Company's RSUs are subject to forfeiture and are expected to vest over two to four years ratably on a combination of bi-annual and quarterly basis. New hire grants vest after 6 months, quarterly thereafter over the 4 years. Refresh grants vest quarterly over 4 years.

Per our SAFE framework, we do not add specific dates to the handbook regarding equity. For more information on grant cadence & vesting, please see the following slide deck.

- RSUs begin vesting on the corresponding grant date.
- RSUs are reviewed for approval quarterly.
- New Hire: 12.5% vest after ~6 months (depending upon grant date - some new hires may wait a bit longer); remaining RSUs vest quarterly thereafter for 3.5 years (four-year total vest).
- Promotion and Refresh Grants do not require a cliff, begin vesting quarterly for four-year vest.

Exercising Your Options

"Exercising your options" means buying the stock per your option agreement. You pay the exercise price that was set when the options were first granted and you receive stock certificates back. To give team members an opportunity to benefit from any existing tax incentives that may be available (including under the US the Dutch tax laws and tax laws of your country of residence) we have made the stock immediately exercisable. This means you can exercise your right to purchase the unvested shares under your option to start your holding period. However, the Company retains a repurchase right for the unvested shares if your employment or other services ends for any reason. An early exercise of unvested stock may have important tax implications and you should consult your tax advisor before making such a decision.

While the company has the right to repurchase the unvested shares upon your termination of services, the company is not obligated to do so. Accordingly you could lose some or all of the investment you made. Because we are a young company there are lots of risks, so be aware and informed of the risks.

You may exercise and hold your options even outside of an open trading window. If you are a Designated Insider, please email stockadmin@gitlab.com and they will enable you to do so in your E-TRADE account. Team members will have 5 trading days to execute their exercise. Please seek advice from your financial advisor or tax advisor prior processing your exercise.

E-TRADE: Exercising your Shares in an Open Trading Window

For trading in an open trading window, please find the following instructions for specifics on exercise and trading options.

- GitLab Stock Plan Non-US
- GitLab Stock Plan RSUs & Stock Options

Purchasing GTLB Stock

If you would like to purchase GTLB shares, this must be done through your ETRADE retail account during an open trading window. We would ask that you send us a message at stockadmin@gitlab.com as we will need to get consent from you to track your GTLB retail shares.

Questions about your stock plan or retail account

E-TRADE Team Member Education Sessions

Equity 101: What You Need to Know About Your GitLab Restricted Stock Units (RSUs)

- U.S. Session
- Non U.S. Session
- Deck with U.S. and Non U.S. materials attached

E-TRADE Securities Customer Service

- US Contact 12 a.m. Monday to 11:59 p.m. Friday ET Closed holidays (800-838-0908)
- Non-US local country contact phone numbers are found here

Customer Service can assist with

- Activating your account
- Navigating the Stock Plan section of etrade.com
- Finding tax information
- Disbursing cash from and depositing cash to your brokerage account
- Buying and selling securities in your brokerage account
- Questions on the portal

Option Expiration

If you leave GitLab, you will generally be able to exercise your options that are vested (as of the last day of service).

In addition, if not otherwise expired (through termination of your employment), your stock options expire 10 years after they were issued.

Exercise Window After Termination

If your employment ends for whatever reason, you have a three month window to exercise your vested options, or lose them. During this window you would have to pay the exercise price and in some cases the tax on the gain in value of your stock options, which could be considerable.

Equity Administration

Administration of (i.e. RSUs, stock options, ESPP share transactions) and equity grant transactions at GitLab are conducted on the ETrade platform. Equity Grants are approved by the Board of Directors "or their designee" at regularly scheduled quarterly board meetings, which contain information relevant to the grant including the number of shares, exercise price, vesting period and other key terms. This information is then recorded in your account at

ETrade. New participant grants, will need to accepted the Grant Agreements in ETrade document under "Grant Acceptance" under the Plan Elections section in your E-TRADE account. Please see GitLab Stock Plan RSUs & Stock Options.

With the implementation of WorkDay, interfaces to ETrade provide for electronic files for status updates to participants, such as terminations and change in Cost Centers.

Taxes

Tax law is complex and you should consult a tax attorney or other tax advisor who is familiar with startup stock options before making any decisions. Please go to the tax team's stock options page for more information on taxation of stock options.

US employees with Incentive Stock Options (ISOs)

Taxation from the US perspective is not as straightforward as you might like. You aren't taxed when you exercise your options. Tax is due on the gain or profit you make when you sell the stock. Depending on your holding period, the tax may be treated as ordinary income or capital gain. Moreover, when you hold the options long enough you may be subject to 0% capital gains tax. To outline the five possibilities of the different scenarios that may apply:

1. Exercise your options to purchase shares, and hold.
1. Exercise your options to purchase shares, and sell the shares within the same year.
1. Exercise your options to purchase shares, and sell the shares in less than twelve months, but during the following year.
1. Sell shares at least one year and a day after you exercised the options, but less than two years from the original grant date.
1. Sell shares at least two years from the original grant date.

Please note, however, that any gain upon exercise of an ISO (difference between the exercise price and fair market value at date of exercise), even if you do not sell the shares, may be counted as a "tax preference" towards the Alternative Minimum Tax limit. For instance, under scenario 1 above you have to make an adjustment in your tax return for the Alternative Minimum Tax (AMT) that equals the so-called bargain element. Each scenario has a different tax treatment, so be careful of the tax consequences when you exercise your options. In the long term, holding onto your stock does save taxes, however be aware of the AMT that you will be confronted with. It is strongly advised that you contact a tax advisor to be aware of the US tax consequences.

In addition to the benefits of a longer holding period, the IRS does have an additional benefit for holders of Qualified Small Business Stock (QSBS for short). GitLab meets the criteria for QSBS treatment for options exercised prior to August, 2018, however (again), the Company is not in a position to offer tax or legal advice nor does it make any representation about compliance with the QSBS provisions, so check with your own tax and financial advisors. We found this article helpful in describing the QSBS program in greater detail.

US service providers with Non-qualified Statutory Options (NQs)

For non-employees of GitLab that have been granted stock options, their stock options are treated as NQs.

GitLab's stock is actively traded on NASDAQ, the NQ is taxed at exercise. The gain of the exercise (fair market value minus the exercise price) has to be reported by form 1099-MISC (box 7). Withholding is typically not required, however when the service provider fails to provide a valued tax identification number in form 1099, GitLab has to ensure backup withholding (roughly 25%).

Netherlands, Germany and Australia

For our team members based in the Netherlands, Germany and Australia, the difference between the exercise price and the fair market value is considered taxable at the date you exercise your stock options. With respect to reporting taxes: the taxable gains are subject to employer tax withholding. The tax payable is therefore deducted from your gross payroll with respect to the exercise of your stock options.

The United Kingdom

In the United Kingdom there is a small difference in the tax treatment of exercising your stock options as opposed to the other entities; the difference between the fair market value and the exercise price is taxed at the date of exercise.

Dual-Class Stock

Often companies will create multiple classes of stock, with each class having different voting rights, in order to provide protection to the company's founders, early investors, and early employees, whose long-term vision for the company may not align with that of later stage investors. At the GitLab Board of Directors meeting held on January 31, 2019, the Board approved the creation of such a dual-class structure.

Effect of Dual-Class Stock

- Class B stockholders retain significant influence over stockholder votes and actions.
- The Influence of long-term Class B stockholders increases as other stockholders from before being public sell or distribute their Class B stock, which converts into Class A common stock upon sale or distribution.

Dual-Class Voting

Class A Common Stock - 1 vote per share

Class B Common Stock - 10 votes per share

Creation of Dual-Class Stock

Being Public

- Class B converts to Class A in sale or distribution unless "permitted transfer" (see below).
- Additional sales of Class A common stock.
- Permitted transfers would be transfers to one or more family members, transfers to a trust for the benefit of the stockholder or in favor of a family member of the stockholder, or transfers to a general partnership, limited partnership, limited liability corporation, or

other entity controlled by the stockholder or a family member of the stockholder.

SECTION: total-rewards/benefits/_index.md

Related Benefits Pages

- General & Entity Specific Benefits
- Modern Health
- Parental Leave and Return Tool Kit for GitLab Managers and Team Members

Introduction

On this page, you can find information about the principles that guide GitLab's benefit strategies and decisions.

Contact Total Rewards

For any questions relating to benefits, please reach out to Total Rewards.

Benefits Strategy and Guiding Principles

These principles will guide our benefit strategies and decisions.

Strategy

- Given Benefits vary by country, we do not offer the same benefits globally, instead we take a country specific approach. We will transparently outline why we do or do not offer benefits.
- Country specific approach based on statutory requirements, entity status, headcount, and market practice
- To provide equitable programs for team members within the same country location when possible.
- To continuously improve the team member experience

Guiding Principles

- Globally aligned benefits with local relevance
- Ensure statutory programs are in place in each country
- Provide core medical, life, and pension benefits either through supplementary or statutory plans
- Create new programs/enhancement with broad reach, high value, and sustainability
- CREDIT: Collaboration, Results, Efficiency, Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging, Transparency
 - Collaboration
 - Work with providers, vendors, and global networks to benchmark benefit data from other similar sized companies.
 - Results
 - Foster Cross Company understanding
 - Results
 - Evangelize benefit programs in each entity.
 - Transform "statutory" to "competitive."

- Make benefits a very real aspect of compensation during the hiring process.
- Measure team member engagement and benefit enrollment.
- Efficiency
 - Iterate on changes for specific countries based on common practices and statutory regulations.
- Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging
 - Actively work to ensure that our benefit choices are inclusive of all team members.
- Iteration
 - Regularly review current benefits (bi-annually) and propose changes.- - Everything is always in draft.
- Transparency
 - Announce and document benefits to keep them updated.
 - Share upcoming benefit plans internally before implementing them.
 - Invite discussion and feedback.

We do not have specific budgets around benefit costs, but instead look to increasing the ability to recruit and retain team members in favorable locations. We do not take a global approach to offering the same benefits in all countries, but will transparently outline why we do or do not offer the above benefits on their respective entity specific benefits page.

Annual Global Benefit Review Process

The Total Rewards team reviews GitLab's global benefits on an annual basis and proposes changes for the next Fiscal Year. The Planning Process is as follows:

1. Team Member Feedback

- In Q2, Total Rewards review team member feedback via the Engagement Survey Results and assess sentiments and gaps within the plans

2. Market Data Collection

- In Q2 & Q3, Total Rewards engages with the benefits broker to collect market data and benchmark benefit plans against other hi-tech employers.
- Benchmarking Data is the broker's proprietary information that GitLab purchases. While some high-level benchmarking information can be shared with team members, most details cannot be disclosed outside of the People Team.

3. Fiscal Year Planning

- In Q3, Total Rewards drafts a Fiscal Year proposal of suggested enhancements and will prioritize based on market practice, statutory regulations, PEO or headcount restrictions and budget.

4. Multinational Pooling Review

- In Q3, Total Rewards will also review the possibility of pooling global plans on an annual basis with our brokers in order to leverage a larger headcount during plan proposals. Multinational pooling merges several employee benefit programs to create an international pool of funds.

The decision to participate in a pooling plan will be based on financial savings, plan options, and better risk control.

5. Plan Approval

- In Q3/Q4, Total Rewards will present the plan to the Finance and Leadership Teams for approval. These proposals will be reviewed and approved along with the greater company budget for the upcoming fiscal year.

6. People Team & Team Member Issues

- Total Rewards will open People Team issues to inform Stakeholders (payroll, legal, finance, tax, etc.) and track the progress of the enhancement.

For major plan enhancements, the Total Rewards team will create a Team Member issue with plan details to get plan specific feedback. While Team Member feedback will be considered as a strong data point, a decision will be made by the Total Rewards team considering all factors (benchmarking, budget, administration, etc). The Total Rewards team may not create an issue if the change or enhancement is a 'smaller' change (i.e. change in deductible amounts, increase in contributions, etc).

7. Announce Enhancements

- Total Rewards will announce the Country Enhancements directly to team members via email and slack, and will update the Handbook Benefit page with these details.

Knowledge Assessment

You can test your knowledge on our benefits by taking the GitLab Benefits Knowledge Assessment quiz. For Job Grades 10+ please select Executive for the My Role Is question on the form.

If you have questions about benefits or the content in the Knowledge Assessment, please reach out to the Total Rewards team. If the quiz is not working or you have not received your certificate after passing the Knowledge Assessment, please reach out to the Learning & Development team.

SECTION: total-rewards/benefits/modern-health.md

Mental Wellness Services

GitLab offers mental health care services to all team members and their eligible family members via Modern Health. Modern Health provides technology and professional support to help reduce stress, feel more engaged, and be happier. Through GitLab, you have access to 6 coaching sessions and 6 therapy sessions each at no cost to you as well as 100+ digital programs & mediations and unlimited live provider-led group sessions or circles.

<iframe src="https://player.vimeo.com/video/680639730?h=d48b608b3f" width="640" height="360" frameborder="0" allow="autoplay; fullscreen; picture-in-picture" allowfullscreen></iframe>
<p>Introducing Modern Health from <a

[Modern Health](https://vimeo.com/modernhealth) on [Vimeo](https://vimeo.com).

For more information on Modern Health and getting started, we recorded an information session in October 2022 that walks team members through valuable information about this benefit and how to start utilizing it.

Check out what GitLab team members are saying about their experience with Modern Health:

1. Mindfulness and Meditation Coaching: I listen to a podcast that referenced a study that showed 12 minutes of meditation a day can improve focus and reduce anxiety/stress. Modern Health has a lot of guided meditations available and I bookmark the 12 minute body scan meditation to perform (almost) every day. I think it's helped me.

1. Career Coaching: I've absolutely had an amazing and helpful experience. My coach helped me advocate for myself, something I've never really felt comfortable doing before. She supported and uplifted me as well, cheering me on as I made improvements and learned how to handle adversity.

1. Confidence Coaching: I've only had one session so far but it was great and led to helpful insights. I'm looking forward to another in a few weeks. I wanted help with imposter syndrome and overall lack of confidence. My coach talked with me about the source of the imposter syndrome, dug in to how it's manifested earlier in my career, and suggested a few strategies for reframing the negativity of my inner dialog into something more productive. I already feel better by having a "to-do" list of things to work on, and I feel a lot more supported and validated. I highly recommend it!

What does Modern Health offer?

Modern Health is the one-stop shop for all tools related to mental well-being and self-improvement. Members gain access to the following features:

- Personalized Plan: Take a well-being assessment and review which tools may be most helpful for you.
- Professional Support: Get matched to a dedicated professional who can help you reach your personal and professional goals. As a GitLab team member, your first 6 coaching sessions are complimentary. After the allotted sessions have been utilized, team members can work directly with the provider to determinate a path forward at an additional cost to the team member.
- Therapy: As of 2021-03-18, GitLab has added Therapy to the offerings through Modern Health. As a GitLab team member, your first 6 therapy sessions are complimentary. After the allotted sessions have been utilized, team members can work directly with the provider to determinate a path forward at an additional cost to the team member.
- Courses: Provider led, self-paced, programs designed to help you navigate specific topics with video content, meditations & programs, and practice assignments. Courses are available on the Modern Health app or online
- Curated Content Library: Learn quick tips and tricks to prevent burnout, manage stress, and cope with anxiety or depression based on our evidence-based digital programs. You can use these digital programs for in-the-moment support or to build your own toolkit of techniques to improve your mental well-being.
- Circles: Live community sessions led by Modern Health therapists and coaches, designed to help you proactively improve your mental health. Access to circles is unlimited and center around topics such as foundations of mental health, healing asian communities, power of women,

and others.

If you're still not sure where to get started, we recommend that you:

1. Download the app and register your account
1. Register and take the well-being assessment and
1. Get matched to a dedicated coach and/or therapist who can work with you to figure out next steps.

Should I see a coach or therapist from Modern Health?

{{< youtube "eyGIRMBrgrc" >}}

Which areas does Modern Health support?

Modern Health cultivates the resilience needed to weather the ups and downs of everyday life. Here are the specific areas where we can help:

Coaching Topic Description
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Work Performance Career Growth, Productivity, Leadership Skills, Work Relationships, Professional Development
Relationships Romantic Relationships & Dating, Family, Friends, Breakups
Stress & Anxiety Anxiety, Depression, Stress, Resilience
Healthy Lifestyles Sleep, Physical Activity, Eating Well, Habits
Financial Well-being Goals, Budgeting Savings and Debt, Management, Investing
Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging Gender, Equality, Unconscious Bias, LGBTQ
Life Challenges Pregnancy/Parenting, Elder/Child Care, Loss of a Loved One, Illness
Mindfulness & Meditation Stress Less, Sleep Better, Focus Better, Meditation for Beginners

Note: This list isn't intended to be comprehensive. Please reach out to help@joinmodernhealth.com with any questions about how or where to get started.

How does Modern Health think about mental health?

The philosophy towards mental health comes from the World Health Organization (WHO): "in which every individual realizes his or her own potential, can cope with the normal stresses of life, can work productively and fruitfully, and is able to make a contribution to her or his community."

How can Modern Health support my career goals?

Professional coaches from Modern Health can help you set, achieve, and stay accountable in your career and personal growth. Professional coaching through Modern Health is a great choice for individuals who have a skill they want to develop, like influence, leadership, or communication styles. Learn more about professional coaching at Modern Health in this 42 second video

Is Modern Health backed by science?

Modern Health's model is grounded in evidence-based approaches, primarily Cognitive Behavioral Therapy, Acceptance and Commitment Therapy, Motivational Interviewing, and Mindfulness.

When do my Modern Health benefits reset?

These benefits reset annually on 03-20.

Note: Unused sessions do not rollover when your benefits reset.

What languages/countries is Modern Health available in?

The platform is currently available in English and Spanish. If English or Spanish is not your preferred language, please note Care is provided in most languages. Feel free to email help@joinmodernhealth.com to find out more.

Modern Health is available globally.

For members that are recommended to therapy and are located in the United States, Canada, Mexico, Costa Rica, France, India, South Korea, Japan, Australia, Ireland, & United Kingdom, they will be able to match with a therapist right within the Modern Health application.

For members that are recommended to therapy and are located outside of one of these countries, the member will be notified that the Modern Health Care Matching team will reach out to the member directly to match them with the best fit therapist based on their needs and their assessment. These members will be introduced to their therapist via email. If a member in this scenario would like to change their therapist, please reach out to help@modernhealth.com.

For members in any location that are not initially recommended to therapy (perhaps, they are recommended to Coaching or another modality of care), but would like to engage with a therapist, we ask that they contact our Member Support team at help@modernhealth.com to express their needs and they will work to make an appropriate match.

What family members are eligible for Modern Health?

Eligible family members are defined as a team member's spouse, legal/domestic partner, children up to the age of 27, and/or children of the team member's legal/domestic partner up to the age of 27.

Adult family members 18+ have full access to Modern Health's resources via the app and their own set of 6 Coaching and 6 Therapy sessions.

Minor Family Members:

- In the US, family members of all ages can be invited to participate in Therapy via Modern Health.
- Globally outside the US, family members ages 6-17 can be invited to participate in Therapy via Modern Health
- In both instances, the eligible parent and/or legal guardian will be responsible for facilitating the minor dependent's introduction to Modern Health. Modern Health will work with the parent/guardian in connecting the minor dependent to Therapy
- Coaching is not available for minors.

Team Member & Family Registration

You can register via the Modern Health Mobile App or on your Desktop Browser:

- Visit my.joinmodernhealth.com on your desktop browser or download the Modern Health app in the Google Play Store (Android) or App Store (iOS) & select "Join Now".
- Use the first and last name you have on file with GitLab.
- Verify using your company email.
- Enter your GitLab email and the password of your choice. (Reminder that you must register with your GitLab email, but you can change your Modern Health account email to your personal email in Settings upon registration.)
- Select "Register" on the web or "Agree & Join" on the mobile app to complete registration.

Once you are registered you can you grant access to your eligible family members via the Modern Health app

- You can invite your adult family members (18+) through the Modern Health app using these instructions
- You can invite minor family members through Modern Health app using these instructions

If you have trouble registering for Modern Health, please don't hesitate to reach out to help@joinmodernhealth.com with a note or screenshot. Their customer support team will verify the information against what they have on file to provide you the best instructions on how to successfully access Modern Health. For new starters, please note that your account might not be immediately available but will be within the first 14 days.

What is the well-being assessment, and why should I take it?

Similar to an annual physical with your primary care physician, Modern Health's well-being survey serves as a check up for your mental health. You can retake the survey to track your progress overtime.

Your well-being score empowers experts at Modern Health to provide you the best user experience. It enhances the customization of your personalized wellness plan, which makes it more effective in addressing your specific needs. Although the ups and downs in well-being score are inevitable, the data-driven approach keeps up with how you're doing over time to support you with the tools to improve no matter where your score is at today.

Care

What is coaching?

Coaching is a collaborative process to help you make important changes in your personal and professional life. Your coach is there to help you figure out how you want to change and the steps you need to take to do so. Your coach's job is to help you organize your thoughts, emotions, and goals and break things down into smaller steps that create forward movement and growth. The client is the driver of these sessions, while the coach is there to provide reflection, clarity, and accountability.

What is therapy?

Therapy is talk-based mental health treatment delivered by licensed clinicians to help with mental health needs. Therapy is appropriate if there is a clinical concern, as defined by the duration of symptoms (e.g., most of the time for two weeks) and their severity (e.g., interfering with someone's ability to function in an important area of life). Those with a clinical need essentially experience symptoms (e.g., depression, anxiety) that are strong, last a long time, and impact the ability to function.

What is the difference between coaching and therapy?

Modern Health's belief is that anyone can benefit from working with a coach, and some people need therapy in addition to or instead of coaching. The primary difference between coaching and therapy is that therapy is conducted by licensed mental health professionals who are trained to treat clinical difficulties (e.g., depression, anxiety), whereas coaches work on non-clinical issues (e.g., personal growth, financial well-being, and professional development). You can maybe think about it as the difference between seeing an orthopedic surgeon and a physical therapist. If you have broken your leg, you should see a surgeon since they are uniquely qualified to support you. But if you've sprained your ankle, a physical therapist is a much better fit. Not only would seeing a surgeon be more intense than you need, but physical therapists are better trained to help you gain strength. In this metaphor, therapists serve as the surgeon and coaches serve as the physical therapist.

Here is a breakdown of the different types of providers in our coaching and therapy networks:

Coaching: Coaches work with individuals to help them have the kind of lives they want. While there is no specific degree or license required to practice as a coach, all Modern Health coaches are rigorously vetted, certified, and trained in evidence-based approaches.

Therapy: Therapy can be provided by therapists or psychologists. Therapists can have a variety of titles (counselors, therapists, clinicians, etc.). What they have in common is a master's degree (M.A., or M.S.) in clinical psychology or a related field and are licensed in the state in which they practice. Common licenses include Licensed Marriage and Family Therapist (LMFT), Licensed Clinical Social Worker (LCSW), and Licensed Professional Counselor (LPC). These therapists are also trained in the assessment and treatment of mental health concerns. Psychologists have a doctoral degree (Ph.D., or Psy.D.) in clinical psychology or a related field such as counseling psychology or education and are licensed in the state in which they practice. They are trained in the assessment and treatment of mental health concerns.

Why do I only see coaching as an option?

Based on your answers to the well-being survey, Modern Health will determine the appropriate care for your level of well-being needs and direct you to match with either a coach and/or a therapist. We believe that everyone can benefit from working with a coach and some people can benefit from working with a therapist if they have a clinical need.

If you weren't matched to a therapist based on your well-being survey, but would still like to be matched with a therapist, you can reach out to help@joinmodernhealth.com and notify the Care Team that you were matched to coaching, but would like to be matched to a therapist. The Care Team will then work with you on your preferences, areas of focus, etc. and make sure you receive great matches for therapy.

How do you match me to a provider?

Modern Health matches you to appropriate coach based on a proprietary algorithm that takes into account your well-being assessment and areas you want to focus on.

How often should I meet with my coach or therapist?

How often you meet with your coach or therapist depends on your personal situation. Some people like to meet weekly, whereas others meet every month or two.

Can I complete sessions with my partner or a family member?

Yes, you are able to use your sessions with your partner or a family member. If you choose to do so, each completed session will count as one of your covered sessions. Please discuss this directly with your coach or therapist.

What can I expect during my first coaching session?

During the first session, your coach will kick things off with an introduction to what coaching is and what you can expect during the session, including reviewing confidentiality (nothing you discuss is shared with Modern Health or your employer unless you request more support or need crisis resources). They will then ask you a few questions to better understand what you hope to get out of the coaching experience and what a successful experience would be for you. By setting expectations up front, the coach will be able to better help you identify personal goals and take steps towards achieving them. In subsequent sessions, the coach will follow up on any action items to understand their impact and you will together come up with next steps. The standard coaching session is 30 minutes and takes place over video, usually every two weeks or once a month. In between sessions, you are encouraged to reach out to your coach with any follow up questions or advice via Modern Health's digital messaging tool in the app as well as utilize the digital CBT and meditation programs.

What can I expect during my first therapy session?

Similar to coaching, therapists will start each session with an introduction and review of expectations and confidentiality to make sure that you feel comfortable with them and the process. They will then ask you a series of questions to get a better understanding of your symptoms and background to best identify how you can work together to achieve your goals. After this initial assessment, they will work collaboratively with you to formulate a treatment plan and review different methods to help you address your needs (e.g. Cognitive Behavioral Therapy, Acceptance and Commitment Therapy, Dialectical Behavior Therapy). They will likely give you some follow up action items that you can take away from the session. In follow up sessions they will review specific action items and alter your treatment plan based on your needs. Typically, therapist visits will be 45-50 minutes in length and occur in person or via video, often weekly.

How should I prepare for my first session?

Before your first session, we encourage you to ask yourself a few questions. As with many other aspects of your life, the more effort you put into your coaching and/or therapy experience, the more you'll get out of it. These can help guide your initial conversations with your coach or

therapist.

- Where do you want to start?
 - You might have a lot of areas of interest (e.g., you want to learn mindfulness, and work on your finances). Spend some time thinking about where you want to get started before your first visit. What is most on your mind or stressing you out?
- Do you know what your goals are or do you need help figuring that out?
- What do you want to get out of coaching or therapy?
- What do you want your coach to be like? Do you want someone who holds you accountable, who is a cheerleader, who challenges you?
- How do you want your life to look when you are done? What does success look like?

What happens if my provider isn't a good fit?

Our goal at Modern Health is to find someone that you feel you can do good work with and who can do good work with you! If you think the first person you meet with doesn't seem like a good fit, just let the Modern Health team know (help@joinmodernhealth.com) and they will connect you with someone new.

Modern Health Manager Resources

Managers can set up Coaching Sessions through Modern Health to receive guidance on managing a team, including advice on how to best support your team's mental health.

Once you register for your Modern Health account, you can add "Managing Others and Supporting a Team" to your topics of focus and schedule a session.

In addition to Coaching, please see additional Modern Health Manager Resources:

- How To Lead Conversations Around Mental Wellness Video & Flyer
- Steps to address Stress & Burnout in the Workplace
- Self-Guided Digital Resources for Managers

Logistics

- You have unlimited access to your coach over text and/or email.
- Coaching and therapy sessions are held over video/phone.
- If you need to miss a scheduled session please let your coach/therapist know at least 24 hours before your appointment. If you cancel after that time, or miss the session, it will count towards your total covered sessions.
- Remember that the GitLab PTO policy and a non-linear workday structure are meant to enable you to make time for your mental health. Team members should feel empowered to make an appointment for therapy in the middle of the day or take time off to attend an appointment.

What do I do if I need support in between sessions?

Beyond sessions, your coach is available through chat to check in on your progress toward your goals, as well as provide ad hoc support when situations come up that you might need advice on, but don't need a full session for. To chat with your coach, click the blue text bubble on the bottom center of the mobile app.

Note: Modern Health is not a crisis resource. If you are experiencing a mental health emergency, please go to the nearest emergency room or contact a local emergency response line. You can find local and international resources by selecting "Information" on the bottom right of your mobile app, and then clicking the red "Access to 24/7 Crisis Information" banner at the top of the screen.

Confidentiality and Security

Does my employer know if I'm using Modern Health?

No, a list of new GitLab team members is sent to Modern Health on a weekly basis so they can update GitLab's database but whether a team member chooses to use Modern Health or not is confidential and will not be shared with GitLab. All information submitted through the Modern Health application is kept confidential and used to deliver a more personalized experience. No individual usage data will ever be shared back with your employer.

Is what I discuss with my coach/therapist confidential?

All information between you and your coach is confidential, except in the following cases:

- You are at risk of harming themselves and/or others
- Child, elder adult, or dependent adult abuse
- Court subpoenas

How do you protect my information?

Hypertext Transfer Protocol Secure (HTTPS) encryption measures for all data exchanged between our members and the application. Conversations are encrypted in transit via SSL (TLS v1.2) and each conversation (between a member and a provider) has its own encryption key which is stored in a separate, secure management system. Message contents are encrypted upon receipt by the web server and are transported and stored in internal systems.

Crisis Support

What do I do in a crisis?

If you are experiencing a crisis (e.g., thoughts about suicide, thoughts about harming yourself or others, medical crisis, or in a dangerous situation) please call:

- emergency responders (911 or the appropriate local emergency number for your area)
- in the US (988 or <https://988lifeline.org/>)
- in the US/Canada, (<https://suicidepreventionlifeline.org/> or 1-800-273-8255) or a crisis line in your area
- head to the nearest emergency room.

Modern Health Weekly Reporting

The purpose of the Modern Health Weekly Reporting is to share a list of new team members to Modern Health to ensure that anyone who joins GitLab will have access to Modern Health within one week of their hire date. The information that Modern Health requires from us are: employee

number, names, work emails, hire date, country, department and job title.

Instructions for Total Rewards:

- Pull the Modern Health Workday report
- Sort by hire date, remove anyone who hasn't started and copy the report
- Open the Modern Health Upload spreadsheet on the google drive and paste the report under a new tab
- Rename the tab to today's date
- Download as a CSV file
- Email the file the secure upload using Box

SECTION: total-rewards/benefits/parental-leave-toolkit.md

Manager Tool Kit

GitLab supports all our team members time away needs by offering multiple leave types in compliance with all applicable federal, state, and laws. At GitLab, we want to support our team members throughout their journey here which includes both the 'highs' and the 'lows'. This includes offering several different leave programs (medical, parental, etc.) to support time away from work, and other resources to support overall well-being, because taking time away from work can be stressful, exciting, and everything in-between.

As a manager, your team members(s) may come to you with questions, concerns, and/or requests for additional support and guidance. These resources are intended to highlight which areas in the leave of absence process you are responsible for, and how you can best support your team members throughout the life-cycle of their leave. No two leaves are ever the same, so there may not always be a "one-size-fits-all" solution. Some leave situations can be exciting and planned for (i.e. Parental Leave) while others may not be able to be planned for and/or may be serious for the team member or their family member. As a Manager it is important you approach each situation with empathy and kindness, and understand how to best support your team member. The resources included in these pages are intended to equip you with the information you need to support your team members through the entire life-cycle of their leave. If you have any questions or need any additional assistance, please contact leaves@domain.

To-Do List

Before the Leave Begins: Your team member informs you they need a leave or more information

1. If Applicable: Your team member may inform you that their physician recommended restrictions or requests accommodations to be able to perform the essential functions of their job before their leave starting. Please contact leaves@domain and the Absence Management Team can assist you with this request.

1. Arrange Out of Office Coverage: This may vary for work functions (i.e sales, etc), so consider asking your team member to create a Leave Plan documenting projects in progress, pending TODO items, ongoing responsibilities, important meetings, etc. via either a Google Doc or an Issue.

- Pro-Tips:

- Consider what happens if the person needs to leave earlier than planned due to medical issues.

- Tag team members covering during the absence.

- Review the Resource Allocation section of the handbook.

1. Ask what communication your team members want while out (if any at all). Some team members may want to stay plugged in a bit and chat informally to ensure they are not forgotten, and others may want to disconnect completely. If the team member does want to chat, please ensure any communication while the team member is on leave is not work related.

Leave Begins: Your team member is off work

Some situations require a team member to start their leave immediately. Hearing that you will support them throughout their leave, and asking how they need your support as they begin their leave will mean a lot and possibly help ease any stress the team member has about beginning their leave.

1. If your team member has not already reported their need for a leave to the Absence Management Team, please ask them to email leaves@domain.

1. Continually update the team member's Leave Plan with any significant changes or events, project progress and updates, etc. to fill them in on once they are back. For example, it may be helpful to link to the specific Group Conversations that pertain to their role for ease in finding these resources upon return.

- Remember to have check-ins with any team member assuming additional responsibilities during the team member's leave:

- Are there deadlines they are up against? Do they need your support? Are they still excited about these extra responsibilities, or do they need additional support from you or other team members?

1-2 weeks prior to your team member returning from leave

1. Consider drafting a transition "in" or a re-immersion plan for your team member, but be open to changes as your team member returns to work. Treat the re-immersion plan as an opportunity to reengage and reenergize your team member. They've been gone a while, and will need time to immerse back into work.

- Depending on how long the team member has been gone, consider detailing how the team member will "ramp back" to work and the duration of the ramp back period.

- Include coffee chats reconnecting with peers, 1:1s checking in with their team or other stakeholders.

- Allow time to review their Leave Plan and catch up on what they missed.

- Consider if any big changes may have occurred that would impact how they work, who they work with, or the general team.

1. For anyone coming back to work there can be high levels of uncertainty on what to expect when they return; remember their time away was not a vacation. It is important that you set aside time on your calendar to connect with them on their first day back at work.

- Check-in with them, see how they are feeling about the transition, and what support they may need from you.

1. Make them feel welcome on their first day back and prepare/consider a small welcome back gift (flowers, small gift, sign/card from the team, etc.)

1. Review the Return from Leave section below to prepare for your team member's first day/week

back at work.

1. Reach out welcoming them back. Share what they can expect on their first day back, and that you'll plan on meeting with them first thing on their first day back.

- We want your team member to see a friendly face on their first day back, and feel comfortable as they return to work.

Return From Leave: First Day Back at Work

Welcome them back! Whether your team member was gone for several months, or just a few weeks, it is important for you to acknowledge their return and let them know how you'll be supporting them. Returning to work after a leave, for some, can cause anxiety so it is important the team member eases back slowly. Recognize that there will be a period of readjustment, and personal and professional reflection; be prepared to be transparent and have productive and supportive conversations.

1. Plan to meet with your team member first. It is important to reconnect with the person that has been on leave, and not jump right into work.

- First, ask how they are doing, how is their family, how was their time away, are they anxious about returning, if so what is causing them anxiety, how would they like to see you show up for them as they transition back, etc.

- Review what they can expect during their first weeks back at work.

- We want our team members to ease back into working, so jumping back into projects or taking on new projects may not be the right choice. Instead they should plan to reconnect with their team, and other cross-functional partners.

- Be prepared to discuss any other questions/concerns that your team member may have upon return.

- Share team/org changes

1. Your team member may provide you with a Return to Work note upon their return from leave. Please forward any return to work notes received to leaves@domain.

1. If Applicable: If your team member informs you they have restrictions, and is requesting accommodations to be able to perform their job, please contact leaves@domain and the Absence Management Team will assist.

1. Team members may block off time on their calendars. Please be respectful of these calendar blocks.

1. Check-in routinely with your team members to ensure they are receiving the appropriate level of support as they transition back to work recognizing that there will be a period of readjustment and personal and professional reflection.

- Check-ins should be done on a regular cadence: 1st day, 1st week, 2 weeks, 1 month, 2-3 months, etc.

- If the transition seems to be progressing differently than anticipated, you can reach out to your People Business Partner or Team Member Relations for support.

- Team members have access to Modern Health if needed.

General Guidelines For Managers on Resource Allocation

If you have a team member going out on parental leave, a common question might be "how should I reallocate their tasks and output while they are out?" Below are general guidelines for managers based on the length of leave taken by the team member. Note - local law supersedes these guidelines where applicable:

- Leave less than 1 month: Use internal resources.
- Leave less than 6 months: Use internal resources who may be eligible for an interim bonus, and/or consider hiring a temporary contractor
- Leave longer than 6 months: Use internal resources who may be eligible for an interim bonus, hire a temporary contractor.
- Leave longer than 1 year: Consider a backfill ensuring there will be a similar (level, scope, etc) role for the person when they return.

Parental Leave Reentry Buddies

We want our team members to feel supported throughout the entire life-cycle of their leave. Returning from any leave is hard, and navigating work and parenthood can be challenging. Parental Leave Reentry Buddies are an important part in supporting our team members returning from leave, and we ask GitLab team members to volunteer (being a parent yourself is not required).

A Parental Leave Reentry Buddy helps team members reconnect with GitLab and ease back into working after parental leave. A Parental Leave Reentry Buddy is an advocate for a successful return to work, and is able to empathize with concerns about reentering the workplace.

Responsibilities may include but are not limited to:

1. Facilitate weekly coffee chats to catch up on non-work topics, and listen to any concerns they have or issues they've encountered since returning to work.
 - Make it fun! Returning to work can be stressful, so coffee chats are a great time to step away from work and talk about something else.
1. Be available to help your team member navigate through any company or departmental changes that occurred while on leave.

Future iterations are still being considered, and will be added to this section as the program evolves. If you have any feedback regarding this program, please contact leaves@domain or share with the People Connect team via HelpLab.

What Makes a Successful Reentry Buddy

1. While it is recommended that this buddy work within the same department as the team member reentering work, it is not a requirement. We just ask that you dedicate your attention and resources to supporting your team member.
 - If you are asked to be a buddy, work with your manager to delegate or temporarily pause certain duties to assist a team member as they ramp back up to 100%.
1. You are passionate about GitLab and its team members.
1. You are able to commit 10-20% of your time for two to four weeks to team members returning from leave.
1. You feel comfortable sharing feedback regarding what is working well, and suggestions for future iterations of this program.
1. (Recommended but not required) You are comfortable with Git and GitLab and can answer team member questions.

Find a Parental Leave Reentry Buddy

Visit the GitLab Team page and search for 'Parental Leave Reentry Buddy', or ask on Slack in [intheparenthood](#).

Volunteer to Become a Parental Leave Reentry Buddy

1. Contact leaves@domain or create a request in HelpLab if you're interested in becoming a Parental Leave Reentry buddy or would like more information.

Adding Parental Leave Reentry Buddy to your GitLab Profile

1. Find your yml file.
1. Add Parental Leave Reentry buddy to the departments section in your entry (keeping your existing departments):

```
yml
departments:
  - ...
  - Parental Leave Reentry buddy
```

1. Add the following code above the expertise section in your entry:

```
yml
expertise: |
  <li><a href="">Parental Leave Reentry buddy</a></li>
```

1. If you already have an expertise section, add the list item portion of the above code:

```
html
  <li><a href="">Parental Leave Reentry buddy</a></li>
```

Virtual Baby (or Growing Your Family) Shower

A nice way to celebrate a team member's new addition to their family is by hosting a virtual baby/growing your family shower. In colocated companies, this is something that teams often do to wish a team member well as they head out on parental or adoption leave. We encourage virtual showers to be considered for all team members (not just birthing parents). In order to help teams host a virtual shower, here are some resources that can help you get started:

1. Ask the team member if they would be comfortable with a virtual shower. In a remote environment, surprising the parent-to-be is less effective as they need to be an active participant in the process.
1. If the team member is comfortable and open to an event, ask them who they would like to include in the celebration and if they have any gift registries that other team members can buy gifts from so they are purchasing items that the baby will need. The purchase of gifts should always be optional.
1. Send out an invite in advance of the event so attendees can plan to be available for that date and time.

1. Create an agenda for the event. Be mindful to create an inclusive and welcoming atmosphere. Consider running potential games by the celebrated team member to ensure comfortability. See a sample agenda below:

- Kick off the meeting by thanking everyone for coming, review the agenda and how games and prizes will be work.

- Start meeting off with opening ice breaker: An option is a Baby MadLibs game.

- Game 1 - Measure the belly. If the soon-to-be parent is a birthing parent, you can play this game. It requires a roll of toilet paper. Participants guess how many sheets of toilet paper it will take to wrap around the birthing parent's belly. The closest guess gets a prize.

- Open presents - Have the soon-to-be parent save the presents shipped to them to be opened during the celebration.

- Game 2 - Songs with the word "Baby." Have part